The Members' Pathway: *Level 3*

RETRIEVE> Understand Reasons for Losses > *Unattached Freemasons*

Once a Freemason has resigned from all of his Lodges, he is termed "unattached" and there are rules governing his rights to visit other Lodges.

However, an unattached Freemason does not need to be a permanent loss to the Craft.

GUIDANCE FOR LODGES

- Many Unattached Freemasons are likely to have become so due to a change in their personal circumstances.
- These include relocation to a different area or a change in job or family circumstances which makes it difficult for them to attend a Lodge meeting.
- Sometimes these circumstances change again, making a return to Freemasonry a possibility.
- Re-engaging with these Brethren can often lead to a consideration to re-join a Lodge.
- During the Covid-19 pandemic many Lodges re-engaged with former members and awakened their interest in re-joining.
- Maintain contact with a member who resigns due to a change in personal circumstances; they may be able to re-join at a later date.
- Opportunities include:

  - the Lodge Almoner could keep in touch with them, sending birthdays cards, etc
  - they could be supplied with information concerning the activities of the Lodge
  - they could be sent Provincial newsletters
  - they could be sent copies of Freemasonry Today
  - they could be invited to social functions
  - their wife or partner may be eligible to remain a member of an Association
  - they will continue to be eligible for Masonic relief grants from the Masonic Charitable Foundation.

- Some Provinces are encouraging their Lodges to locate Unattached Freemasons within their area and to invite them to a Lodge meeting, to re-kindle their interest in the Craft.